

Germany

Sovereign government data centre network — capacity, legal posture, provider landscape and migration path.

1 Starting point

Population	83.58 m
GDP	EUR 4,470 bn
Public administration (NACE O)	3,041 k
Electricity price	226.4 EUR/MWh
Renewables	54.1%
Live hyperscaler regions	6

2 What is structurally different

- Expensive power (226 EUR/MWh vs. EU average ~184). Power is the dominant OPEX line; free cooling, heat reuse, and siting near renewables or nuclear baseload move the economics more than server choice does. The model's power OPEX line is the number to attack first.
- Dense hyperscaler presence (6 live regions). Commercial capacity, fibre and skills exist in-country; the sovereign core can stay lean and the hybrid model works as designed. The risk is the opposite one: political pressure to declare a hyperscaler region 'sovereign enough' (Dutch GOAL.md section 17: location is not sovereignty).

3 Capacity

Servers	24,531 (CPU 16,916 / GPU 1,146 / storage 6,469)
IT critical load	40.3 MW
Facility design load	60.4 MW
Sites	6 (by capacity 6, floor 4)
Average per site	10.1 MW
Site count set by	capacity
CAPEX	EUR 1.44 bn
OPEX	EUR 164 m / yr

4 Proposed geography

Region	Role	Share	MW	Notes
Frankfurt - Rhine-Main	Primary civil cloud	36%	21.7	DE-CIX, ITZBund estate; grid saturated - expect multi-year connection lead time.

Region	Role	Share	MW	Notes
Berlin - Brandenburg	Sovereign secondary	18%	10.9	Federal ministries, AWS ESC and STACKIT prove grid headroom in the east.
Munich / Bavaria	Defense / industrial	18%	10.9	Defense-industrial cluster, Bundeswehr IT; southern separation.
Hamburg / North	Government / continuity	18%	10.9	Wind surplus, North Sea cable landings (Norden/Sylt).
Leipzig - Saxony	Strategic reserve	10%	6.0	Post-coal land and grid; reserve/expansion.

First-pass geographic hypotheses encoding only the obvious constraints, to be replaced by scored site selection.

5 Legal and regulatory posture

Governing instrument	Onlinezugangsgesetz; IT-Planungsrat Deutsche Verwaltungscloud-Strategie (DVC)
Cloud certification	BSI C5 (Cloud Computing Compliance Criteria Catalogue)
Data classification	Verschlusssachenanweisung (VSA): VS-NfD / VS-Vertraulich / Geheim / Streng Geheim
Procurement route	Beschaffungsamt des BMI and Kaufhaus des Bundes; ITZBund as federal operator

Foreign jurisdiction exposure. Delos Cloud (SAP/Arvato on Azure, BSI-aligned) for federal workloads; M365 use contested by the Datenschutzkonferenz

Under the US CLOUD Act and FISA 702 a provider subject to US jurisdiction can face a lawful order for data it holds regardless of where that data sits. Residency is necessary but not sufficient; what matters is who holds the keys and who can be compelled.

6 Current state and provider landscape

Government cloud	Deutsche Verwaltungscloud (DVC) federated launched Mar 2025 (IT-Planungsrat/govdigital/FITKO); Bundescloud (ITZBund); Delos Cloud (SAP/Arvato on Azure, BSI-aligned); openDesk (ZenDiS); STACKIT/IONOS/T-Cloud; BSI C5
Maturity	federated
Digital identity	Online-Ausweis eID + BundID/DeutschlandID
Interconnection	DE-CIX Frankfurt (world's largest) Hamburg Munich; Norden/Sylt/Rostock landings

7 Migration path and cost

Phase	Scope	MW	CAPEX	Cumulative	Hybrid
1	Sovereign core	14.7	EUR 281 m	20%	no
2	Security and defense	18.8	EUR 456 m	51%	no
3	State record	10.5	EUR 265 m	70%	no
4	Elective	16.4	EUR 433 m	100%	yes

Phase 1 is the number that matters: **EUR 281 m** for 14.7 MW, 20% of total CAPEX. That is the floor below which no hybrid arrangement helps — and it is a small fraction of the full build.

8 Geography and threat notes

Low seismic; Ahr/Rhine/Elbe floods (2021); Frankfurt grid saturated (multi-year waits) with headroom in Brandenburg/east; 3rd-highest EU power price; north-south grid bottlenecks; LNG gas import; NATO; sabotage/drone incidents at DCs 2024-25